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July 27, 2026

Praveen Palaniswamy
[redacted]

Dear Praveen

Please allow this letter to serve as a thank you and acknowledgment of the volunteer service as an evaluator for the Society for Science's 2026 Thermo Fisher Scientific Junior Innovators Challenge STEM competition.

Thermo Fisher JIC is the nation's premier Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics (STEM) competition for 6th, 7th, and 8th grade students. Annually, thousands of middle school students participate at Society-affiliated fairs across the country. Typically, the top 10% of middle school fair participants are selected to enter the national competition. Ultimately, 30 finalists are invited to participate in finals week, showcasing their research and working in teams on hands-on STEM challenges, competing for over $100,000 in awards.

The Thermo Fisher JIC evaluators are charged with reading and scoring a subset of the total applications (approximately 3,500 this year) in their subject matter expertise, ultimately helping to determine the Top 300 Junior Innovators and finalists for the competition, along with a panel of judges. Evaluators comments are also used by judges to determine the 30 finalists of the competition. Your time and effort spent evaluating applications is extremely appreciated. This is a significant time commitment in after-hours reading and reviewing that can never be properly compensated. You represent your institution and profession exceptionally well via this service.

Please do not hesitate to contact me if there is anything additional, I can provide in support and thanks to acknowledge the volunteer service you so graciously provide. I can be reached at rramadorai@societyforscience.org.

Sincerely,



Raeva Ramadorai, Thermo Fisher JIC Program Director
Science Education Programs
Society for Science

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